

Welcome to Vista La Mesa Christian Church!

We are so glad you joined us for worship this morning! We hope you will experience God's deep and unconditional love for you while you are here today.

Vista La Mesa Christian Church (or VLM, as we call it) is a congregation of the Christian Church (Disciples of Christ) in the US and Canada. We humbly acknowledge that we live and serve on the ancestral and unceded territory of the Kumeyaay people. We celebrate the unity and diversity of the Body of Christ, working to make visible the oneness of the Church across all divisions, locally and globally. We celebrate the Lord's Supper (communion) every Sunday and invite everyone to participate, whether you're a member here or not. We will also receive an offering during the service, but we consider your presence with us today your gift!

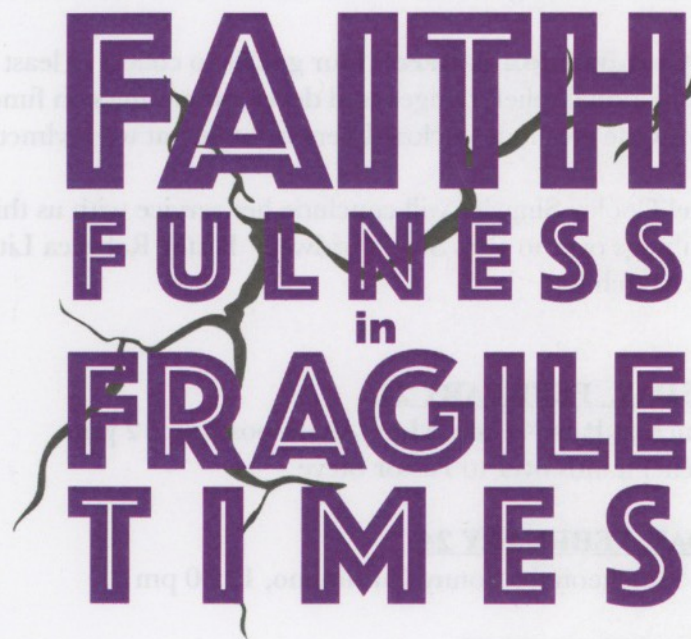
You can follow along in this program ("the bulletin") to see what is happening in each moment of the service. There is no part of worship that you are not invited to participate in. If you need more information, ask someone nearby, and they'll be happy to help you.

You are welcome to keep your children in worship with you! If you would like to have them participate in our children's ministries, they are welcome to do that too. Our staffed nursery is open for infants and younger kids. Older children are invited out for an age-appropriate faith experience after their moment of acknowledgement, as needed. There are also "quiet worship" bags in the entryway, for children who might be restless. But know that we believe that the sound of children in worship is a joyful noise!

After worship, **we'd love to have you join us at coffee hour** in Bailey Hall, with coffee and treats. The restrooms and a drinking fountain are off the hallway at the back of Bailey Hall.

We are glad you are here!

Vista La Mesa Christian Church
(Disciples of Christ)



February 18, 2024
First Sunday in Lent

ANNOUNCEMENTS & CALENDAR

Masks are available at both entrances for those who would like to wear one in the building.

Lent has begun. Our theme is “Faithfulness in Fragile Times,” and our sermon series is focusing on the central values & practices of our faith that get us through difficulty. If you didn’t get one of the Ash Wednesday blessing packets this past week, you can pick one up in the back of the Sanctuary. We encourage to share that “church card” with a friend!

Week of Compassion is here! Our goal is to collect at least \$500 for our denominational relief, refugee and development mission fund. You can give with the envelope enclosed here or online at www.vlmcc.org.

Rev. Rachel Cooley Shawler will conclude her service with us this week and hand things over to Rev. Steve Bridwell. Pastor Rebecca Littlejohn returns on March 6.

WEDNESDAY, FEBRUARY 21

Lunch Bunch at Patty’s Cafe (Mary Alynn hosting), 12 pm
Pastor Rachel hands over to Pastor Steve

SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 24

Memorial Luncheon for Sonny Cusumano, 12:30 pm

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 25

Disciples Class, 9 am (Bailey Hall & Zoom)
Week of Compassion concludes

*Happy Birthday to you, Anniversaries too.
May God richly bless you another year through!*

ORDER OF WORSHIP

**At these points, you are invited to rise in body or spirit, as feels worshipful to you.*

Prelude Deborah Wilson

Welcome & Announcements Pastor Rachel

***Gathering Song** #82
“His Eye Is on the Sparrow”

***Responsive Call to Worship** Mary Jane Fay

One: Friends, God is inviting us into this space, into this community,
into new life in Christ - each of us and all of us together.

**All: We will remember that we are One in the Spirit, that we
are ever connected to all creation.**

One: As we center our hearts for worship, let us prepare to hear God’s
assurance of our covenant.

**All: God will provide resources & people to support us, and
will give comfort when the road gets rough.**

One: Though we are limited and mistaken, God comes to meet us
where & how we are. Let us worship the Living God with humble
thanksgiving and joy!

**All: Thanks be to God: Creator, Redeemer, Sustainer, whose
grace surrounds us & flows through all creation.**

***Opening Prayer** Mary Jane Fay

Special Music Tim & Karen Cliffe
“Charity”

Moment to Acknowledge our Youngest Disciples & Zoomers

One: Good morning, [name]! Child/Zoomers: Good morning!

ALL: God loves you, [name]!

*Children are now invited to a special worship learning
experience in the Education Wing*

Time of Prayer

Prayers of the People

The Congregation

You are invited to send your prayer requests to the Pastor throughout the week.

Response ~ (One) God, in your mercy, (All) **hear our prayer.** OR
(One) God, with joyful hearts, (All) **we give you thanks!**

Prayer Song

#569

Jesus, remember me, when you come into your kingdom. (2x)

Pastoral Prayer

Pastor Rachel

First Reading

Jennefer Lehton
Psalm 25: 1-10 (OT p. 502)

Week of Compassion Video ~ “Gifts to Live On”

Second Reading

Luke 21: 1-4 (NT p. 85)

The Good News

“A Grace-Filled Life”

Pastor Rachel

Invitation to Discipleship

Pastor Rachel

If you desire to unite with this congregation by confession of faith or transfer of membership, please come forward during the last verse of the Hymn of Response.

***Hymn of Response**

#452

“Here I Am, Lord”

Invitation to the Special Offering

Michael Lewis

If you are visiting with us, we consider your presence a gift.

Bringing Our Gifts ~ Offertory

Deborah Wilson

***Sung Response**

#568

***Prayer of Dedication**

Tim Cliffe

Litany of Preparation

One: In this season of reflection, we confess our fragility, even as we lean on God's faithfulness. We pause now, before we come to Christ's Table, to turn with our whole hearts back toward God.

All: May we find ourselves once again in rhythm with the heartbeat of God's compassion.

One: The peace of Christ be with you.

All: And also with you.

(pause for reflection)

One: May we find our place, once again, in the tender arms of God's love. May our faith be renewed in the gentle presence of Christ our Lord. May the Holy Spirit grant us rest and strength.

All: Amen.

Invitation to Communion and the Words of Institution

Pastor Rachel

Prayer for the Bread and the Cup with The Lord's Prayer

Cheryl Davis-Plotts

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory forever. Amen.

Communion Hymn

#391

“These I Lay Down”

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

This is Christ's Table. All are welcome to partake.

You are invited to share in this holy meal, by receiving one of the sealed communion cups offered from the tray by the deacon. Please allow the deacons to serve each person directly. Gluten-free wafers are available in the cups in the center section of the tray for those with gluten sensitivities. Please take your empty cups and their seals with you when you leave. There are waste baskets near the exit doors.

***Hymn of Going Forth**

#431

"Go, My Children, with My Blessing"

***Benediction & Sung Benediction**

May God go before you to lead you, behind you to protect you, beneath you to support you, beside you to befriend you. Do not be afraid. May the blessing of God, the Son, and the Holy Spirit be upon you. Do not be afraid. Let us go forth to serve.

When you walk from here, when you walk from here,
walk with justice, walk with mercy, and with God's humble care.
(repeat)

***Postlude**

Deborah Wilson

Church Office: (619) 463-9909
Office Email: admin@vlmcc.com

Church Website: www.vlmcc.org
Pastor's Email: pastor@vlmcc.com

CHURCH STAFF

Senior Pastor: Rev. Rebecca Littlejohn

Sabbatical Interims: Rev. Rachel Cooley Shawler and Rev. Steve Bridwell

Secretary: Krista Trimlett

Music Director: Deborah Wilson

Nursery: Stephanie Cadiero

Custodian: Scott Tiemann

Thank You**Serving Feb 18****Serving Feb 24****Communion
Set Up/Clean Up**

Daphne Flores

Daphne Flores

Worship Leader

Mary Jane Fay

Michael Lewis

Lay Reader

Jennefer Lehton

Jerry Bailey

**Offering
Invitation**

Michael Lewis

SUBSTITUTE
NEEDED**Elders**Tim Cliffe
Cheryl Davis-PlottsCheryl Davis-Plotts
Mary Jane Fay**Deacons**Jenny Angione
Claudette Toland
Lyn Van WinkleAl Flores
Daphne Flores
Tracy Stockdall**Children's
Ministries**

Stephanie Cadiero

Stephanie Cadiero

GreetersMary Jane Fay
John LehtonRay Adsit
Michael Lewis**Offering
Counters**Tracy Stockdall
John LehtonMary Alynn Fallon
Andy Cliffe**AV Tech**

Jenny Angione

Mary Alynn Fallon

Zoom Tech

Julie Germain

Michaela Stockdall

**Coffee Hour
Hosts**Jenny Angione
Claudette Toland
Lyn Van WinkleJenny Angione
Claudette Toland
Lyn Van Winkle